

DigiPick of the month



WIN!

A World Connect adaptor by Travel Pac worth Rs 1,150 just by sharing an amusing picture with a tech angle to it. The picture should be shot by you, and should not have been published earlier. Send your picture to digipick@thinkdigit.com. The prize-winning picture will be published each month.

Your friendly
neighbourhood repair shop!

This month's winner is David Paul from Nagpur

Integral Optical Mouse

by Travel Pac

It is an optical laser mouse, 800 dpi and USB connector for predominantly laptop users with a three years warranty agt manufacturing defects. It comes with optical glow scrollers and is compatible with windows NT/2000, 98SE/ME, XP, MacO/S 8.6 or later. The retractable cord can be stored inside the mouse.



as in <http://http://www.thinkdigit.com>, what do you expect? A "Page Not Found" error, of course, or something to that effect. Instead, you are taken to Microsoft's Web site. Try it!

What really happens is that when Firefox is faced with an address it doesn't understand, it takes Google's help—as in the "I'm Feeling Lucky" option. Thus, if you type in <http://ftp://thinkdigit.com>, the keyword noted is "ftp," and you are taken to the homepage of the CuteFTP FTP client.

But then again, why should the "http" lead to Microsoft's site? Apparently, Google is convinced that "http"—meaning virtually the entire Internet as we all know it—is related to Microsoft, in a sense.

MS SEARCH FASTER

What MS Didn't Tell You...

Microsoft recently released a beta version of its own desktop search, similar to Google's. The

funny thing is that in Windows XP and 2000, the features required to do fast hard disk searches are already there. You just haven't ever used them—and that's because MS didn't tell you how to.

You probably know about XP's Windows Indexing Service, which archives files for "fast search". And you have also probably noticed that the search is not really fast. In fact, it's not fast at all. We talked about this in the December 2004 issue of *Digit*—in the 'Tech Nightmares' section, and suggested installing Google Desktop Search because XP's search is too slow.

Now here's something we didn't know then: you can actually use the fast Indexing Service. Here's how: turn on the Indexing Service, and leave it on for a few hours so that all your drives get indexed. Then, open the Windows "File Search" box. Now, type only in the space labelled "A word or phrase in the file".

To find a word inside a file, simply prefix it with "!" and to find a file with a certain name, prefix it with "@filename". So if you want

to find documents with the word "Digit" in them, you would have to search for "IDigit". This works lightning fast—just like Google's Desktop Search!

Coming back to the question—why did MS hide this vital information from us? The new desktop search tool uses basically the same thing, with a nicer interface. Strange stuff!

FINAL MESSAGE

Hacking While On Death Row!

Two years ago, Imam Samudra was charged with engineering the devastating Bali nightclub bombings and sentenced to death. When Samudra published his autobiography this fall, the fact that it contained virulent justifications for the Bali attacks was not surprising.

But at the end of the book is a chapter of an entirely different type, titled "Hacking, Why Not?" Here, Samudra urges fellow radicals to take the holy war

People Who Changed Computing

Vinton Cerf

The year 2004 marked the 30th anniversary of the publication of the first paper on the Internet. Titled "A Protocol for Packet Network Intercommunication," co-authored by Vinton G Cerf



and Robert E Kahn. Little did people know then that this

research effort would spawn countless initiatives by individuals and organisations to explore the applications made possible by a network of hundreds of millions of machines.

It's a lovely coincidence that the Father of the Internet should have a name that sounds the same as "surf". During his tenure from 1976 to 1982 with the United States Department of Defense's Advanced Research Projects Agency (DARPA), Vinton Cerf played a key role in leading the development of Internet and Internet-related data packet and security technologies. This included co-designing the TCP/IP protocol with Kahn. It is not an exaggeration to say that without TCP/IP, there would be no Internet as we know it now. Cerf's working TCP/IP architecture became the official protocol suite of the ARPANET in 1982.

In December 1997, he, along Kahn, was presented the US National Medal of Technology by former President Bill Clinton.

Cerf's own words on "How the Internet Came to Be" are at http://snipurl.com/digit_net.